



Ontario Poverty Reduction Strategy Submission

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Introduction

My name is Julie Jamieson. I am the founder of Misfit Genius, a social-impact venture based in Ontario, and the creator of CANOVA.SYS™, a dignity-centred stewardship model designed to support individuals, strengthen communities and improve local resilience.

My work focuses on designing simple, practical pathways that support stability through contribution, skill-building and community connection. My perspective comes from observing consistent patterns in communities, listening to public accounts of poverty-related barriers, and studying how instability affects daily life. These observations helped shape the foundation of CANOVA.SYS™ and continue to guide its development.

How Poverty Shows Up in Communities

Poverty influences every part of daily life. It limits choice, undermines stability and creates sustained stress. Many people want to contribute and rebuild their futures, yet find themselves navigating systems that are complex, slow to respond or not suited to their circumstances.

Common barriers include limited transportation, unpredictable income, long gaps in employment, lack of safe housing, social isolation and pressure on mental health. These conditions make it difficult to take the first step, even when individuals are motivated and capable.

What Helps

The most effective supports are predictable, simple to access and grounded in dignity. Community-based programs in Waterloo Region that combine contribution, learning and connection often help people regain confidence and create steady routines. When individuals are invited to take part in meaningful activities, they begin to rebuild trust in themselves and feel a renewed sense of purpose.



CANOVA.SYS™ as a Pathway Toward Stability

CANOVA.SYS™ was developed from these observations. It creates a structured way for individuals to earn value through measurable acts of care, including:

- environmental restoration
- stewardship work
- food security initiatives
- community gardens
- local sustainability projects

This approach recognises effort, strengthens confidence and creates a sense of belonging. People build routines, gain experience and reconnect with their community. They can move toward independence at a pace that respects their circumstances. CANOVA.SYS™ supports dignity, strengthens neighbourhood ties and offers a clear pathway into contribution and, over time, employment.

Priorities for Ontario

Ontario's next poverty reduction strategy should focus on:

- simple, predictable support
- dignity-centred pathways that rebuild confidence
- community-rooted programs that reduce isolation
- skill-building that supports long-term stability
- practical systems that recognise effort and potential

People thrive when they feel seen, supported and included. Lasting poverty reduction begins from that foundation.

Closing

Thank you for the opportunity to contribute to this strategy. I would welcome the chance to participate further and share more about CANOVA.SYS™ and the community-based insights that guide this work.